

**Paces AI Inc.**

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Before the Federal Energy Regulatory Commission (Washington, DC 20426)

Re: Interconnection of Large Loads to the Interstate Transmission System

Docket No. RM26-4-000

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Submitter:

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Executive Summary

Paces builds AI agents that run the same power-flow tools utilities use today (TARA, PSS®E, etc.), but in fully automated workflows that let power engineers complete interconnection studies up to **20x faster** with full audit trails and sign-off. We combine that capability with a land attribute focused analysis for large load developments which identifies where upgrades should occur.

Capabilities and Findings

Paces achieved a technical AI breakthrough in June 2025, which enables Paces built AI agents to prepare and operate the standard power simulation tools (TARA, PSS®E, etc.) used by grid operators, utilities and transmission operators to the same quality level as an expert power engineer, but in a fraction of the time. Report outputs for large load withdrawal capacity N-1-1 type studies with thermal/voltages constraints take hours rather than the typical days or weeks, including human expert review. This capability is now being used by utilities and large load developers to speed up interconnection insights and processes.

Second, Paces recently completed an analysis on ERCOT, "[*The Grid is Planning for Data Centers that Will Never Exist*](#)," where we:

- Screen every parcel in ERCOT for data-center-ready land.
- Overlay full withdrawal headroom for large loads.

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We find that currently planned upgrades do not line up with large load and data center demand.

In summary: **manual study processes and speculative, project-by-project signals are producing slow interconnection queues and plans for load that will never be built, while a small set of constraints strands the load that actually can be built.**

FERC's large-loads rule is the chance to fix both problems.

Who We Are

Paces works with utilities, grid planners, and large-load developers to:

- Automate interconnection, cluster, and headroom studies with AI agents running existing and custom tools;
- Identify "upgrade hotspots" where a small number of grid projects unlock many viable sites.

Our Proposal to FERC

We recommend that the Commission:

1. **Explicitly endorse AI automation for large load study and grid planning workflows**
 - State that transmission providers are encouraged to use AI agents to operate approved study tools and scripts, as long as qualified engineers own the methodology and sign-off and workflows are auditable.
 - Encourage or require a SLA of <20 business days for all large load initial studies which makes the leveraging of AI automation essential to meet such a timeline.
2. **Require bottom-up, land-aware planning signals**
 - Direct transmission providers that face material large-load growth to build parcel-level maps of developable large-load sites (zoning, setbacks, floodplains, water, ownership, etc.) and overlay them with bus-level withdrawal headroom.



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- Use these maps as an explicit input to both transmission planning and large-load interconnection.

3. Tie expedited treatment to “power-ready” locations

- Allow the fastest interconnection tracks for large loads that are **(a)** dispatchable/curtailable **and (b)** sited at buses with positive headroom and nearby developable land.
- Permit slower timelines and clearer upgrade expectations for heavily constrained, non-power-ready locations.

Request for Technical Engagement

We respectfully request that the Commission or its staff convene a **technical conference or workshop on “AI Agent Automation use in Large Load Interconnection,”** and we would welcome the opportunity to present our concrete, real world examples.

Conclusion

The Secretary’s 403 letter correctly recognizes that unmanaged large-load growth is a system-level risk. But the real operational risk is mis-located, speculative load plus manual-only study processes that cannot scale.

By:

- Embracing AI agent automation inside existing reliability frameworks
- Requiring land-first, constraint-aware planning signals

The Commission can make “timely and orderly” large-load interconnection achievable faster than by any other means while maintaining grid stability.

Respectfully submitted,

James McWalter

Chief Executive Officer, Paces, Inc.